

Arlington GOP Seeks to Maintain Board Control

(Continued from Page One)

Charges of favoring special interest groups resulted in the business tax reduction, contend the Independents.

The property tax reduction allowed by the GOP this year was scant compared to the one allowed by the ABC board last year, charge the Independents.

THE REPUBLICANS have vowed to do away with the business tax altogether if they maintain control because they contend that if the tax is continued, business will not be attracted to Arlington. The Independents answer that the tax is not as great a problem in attracting business as is the traffic - congested streets and inadequate parking facilities.

The streets and parking problems leave the door open for the Independents to level another charge - that the Republicans do not favor participation in regional activities such as the rapid rail transit system.

The GOP - controlled board, they say, made officials from the Washington Metropolitan Area Transit Authority, the govern-

ing body of the proposed \$2 billion system, come crawling to Arlington to put up its share of funds for the planning stages of the system.

The Independents contend that the system will ultimately save Arlington's transit riders countless dollars a year for commuters and many hours of travel. The Republicans say they are leary that the system will ever be completed if Virginia doesn't help the Northern Virginia jurisdictions with the cost.

THEY SAY they don't want to throw county money down a hole and will watch every step the WMATA takes.

Also on the regional level is the question of Arlington's participation in the Northern Virginia Regional Park Authority, which buys parkland for all Northern Virginians.

The GOP takes the stand that Arlington shouldn't give funds to the park authority to acquire land in Fairfax and Prince William Counties because it is inaccessible to Arlingtonians.

They decided to eliminate all funds for the NVRPA this fiscal

year but have donated nearly \$500,000 over past years.

The non-partisans say that there is only 550 acres of parkland in Arlington to serve 185,000 residents - "an area less than that needed for a fair sized side porch per person."

OTHER ISSUES have weaved in and out of the scores of speeches delivered by the hard-working candidates during recent months.

Casto and Phillips have attacked the school board's policy of "unnecessary busing" students from one school to another.

The ABC - controlled school board say that they only bus children "when necessary."

All of the candidates have publicly pledged to support the neighborhood school system.

Open Occupancy, a question that has touched elections in other areas of the country, has been almost non-existent in this campaign.

The camps are, however, split in their views of the question.

The GOP has defended their right to sell their houses to any one they choose and have label-

ed this right as "one of the most important human rights - the right to own property."

ON THE other hand, the Independents are favoring what they call "community dialogue" which entails getting civic groups together to discuss their views on the situation.

The candidates have their own views of what is the most important issue in the race.

Casto and Phillips contend that the Republican record of the incumbent majority, that has brought a tax decrease and a service increase to the people, should be the foremost point considered.

Fisher and Ricks say that the question on all voters' minds should be "is Arlington going to keep pace with progress?"

The biographies and records of the candidates are impressive and all four have glittering qualifications to serve on the board.

Casto, the current chairman is 43 years old and a long-term resident of Arlington.

HE IS A graduate of Virginia Polytechnic Institute and served as a combat paratrooper in

World War II.

He is the founder and president of the Arlington Securities Corporation, and now serves as manager of the Arlington Branch Office of Auchincloss, Parker and Riddpath, a stock brokerage firm. Living with his wife and three children at 3537 N. Abingdon St., Casto has been a member of several civic and school groups.

His three children, Carol, 17, a graduate of Yorktown High School; Rob, 15, and John, 13, both attending Williamsburg Junior High, keep his wife Vera busy.

The other incumbent is Fisher. **ANOTHER** long-time resident of Arlington, Fisher is president of Resources for the Future, Inc., a private research and education foundation in Washington.

He holds three degrees, a B.S. from Bowdoin, a M.A. in education from George Washington and a Ph.D. in economics from Harvard.

The astute Fisher is the former chairman of the County board, and a former member and chairman of the Arlington Planning Commission.

He has been a member of numerous civic groups and is a former PTA president, plus serving as a member of the school advisory commission.

Nationally, he has served under Presidents Truman and Eisenhower as the senior staff member of the Council of Economic Advisors.

His wife, Peggy, and Fisher have seven children ranging in age from 8 to 24, and the couple have sent their children through Arlington's schools. They live at 2808 N. 24th St.

PHILLIPS, 45, is a native Arlingtonian and a graduate of its public schools.

He is employed with the Chesapeake and Potomac Telephone Co. as a marketing personnel supervisor.

Phillips has been active in youth activities for many years and in 1964 received the youth appreciation award for his service with the Arlington Recreation Department.

He is a Coast Guard veteran and of World War II and attended Southeastern University. He and his wife, Dorothy, have

three children: Sherryll, 24, Scott, 21, and Dean, 15 and live at 3012 N. 23rd Street.

Ricks is the lawyer of the group. **HE WORKS** for the law firm of Hogan and Harrison in Washington and has served as vice-chairman of the Arlington Board of Zoning Appeals, and also as a member of the Expenditures Committee of Arlington County. He claims membership in the Madison PTA and the Arlington Committee of 100.

Ricks, 35, graduated at the head of his class at Georgetown Law School and is on the staff of the school as a lecturer. His wife, Debbie, met Ricks

at Swanson Junior High and both attended Washington-Lee High School, where she was a cheerleader and he was a football star.

The couple have three children, Douglas, 5, Stephen, 3, and Catherine, 2 and live at 3153 N. Military Road.

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